



But here's the real question: *What did you think hyperbitcoinization would look like?* A collection of zines? Cozy lightning meetups until the state withers away?

COLLECT THEM ALL!



894 857
\$94876

Apr 26 - May 2
ISSUE #6

Note from the Editor

Honestly, I don't think it's super cool to accuse one another of suspicious activity in the name of the state. Of course, in this adversarial environment, one would be well within their rights to harbor warranted suspicions. However, in the event that one may have real suspicions, would it be forgivable to publish these publicly? I'm not so sure. Suspicion cannot equal accusation.

Anyway, aren't we having fun?



For Your Consideration

I ask you, consumers of SNZ, how's it going?

- Is there something missing from this publication?
- Are the presentations of top stories tasteful?
- If you run a meetup, can I send you a stack?



made in Austin

by @plebpoet

plus @k00b was there
and also @ek

The Highest Paid Snarks of All SN Time

As of May 2 2025

Don't come for me over this list.

I'm literally just a girl.

Query

```
1 SELECT "Item".id, "Item".msats, "Item".text, u.name
2 FROM "Item"
3 JOIN users u ON u.id = "Item"."userId"
4 WHERE "Item".text ~* 'nice try,? fed' AND "Item"."parentId" IS NOT NULL
5 ORDER BY msats DESC
6 LIMIT 10;
```

Result

id	msats	text	name
570,924	2,500,000	NICE TRY FED! 😊 How much is that worth?	Hamstr
372,821	1,576,299	Nice try, fed. (It obviously never gets old for me)	siggy47
525,777	1,121,000	Nice try, fed.	Undisciplined
412,494	1,100,623	Nice try, fed.	siggy47
397,921	1,023,776	I'd like to select "Nice try fed!"; but it wasn't available.	Undisciplined
488,098	813,000	Despite your impressive smoke screen, you have still earned a ... Nice try, fed.	siggy47
231,929	743,000	Nice try fed	Undisciplined
299,789	669,983	Question 2 you ask for an email address? Nice try, fed	siggy47
341,644	514,033	Nice try, fed.	siggy47
243,155	437,994	Nice try fed! We're all bots here. I promise.	Undisciplined

Lesson

43 sats \ 0 replies \ @grayruby 25 Aug 2024

Getting a nice try fed response on SN is kind of like darthcoin calling you a shitcoiner. It's a rite of passage.

Top Boost

Keychat is now live on the Apple App Store!

2519 sats \ 10k boost \ 12 comments

@Keychat_io 27 Apr bitcoin

Keychat is the super app for Bitcoiners.

Autonomous IDs, Bitcoin ecash wallet, secure chat, and rich mini apps — all in Keychat.

Autonomy. Security. Richness.

Keychat



Gavin Andresen gave a Bitcoin talk @ CIA - Here are the slides

929 sats \ 6 comments \ @raw_avocado 28 Apr bitcoin

#965204

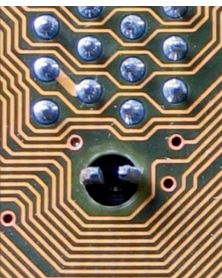
☞ Monday, June 20, 2011

The Bitcoin Project is an experiment - a very ambitious experiment. The goal of the project is to create a better international currency and payment network - one that is stable and secure, and one that gives people more direct control over their finances. ☞

Bitcoin is Payment Network

Decentralized
Node-to-node

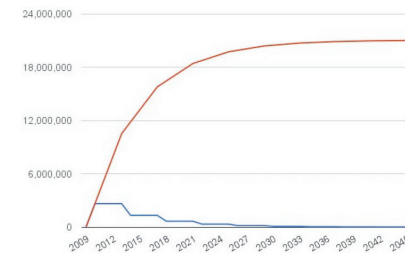
Source:



☞ Bitcoin is also a global peer-to-peer network, across which transactions are broadcast. Your computer must be connected to the Internet to send or receive transaction, but there are no sign-up requirements or fees to pay; anybody can join and participate in the payment network. There is no central organization with a list of approved Bitcoin Payment Processors.

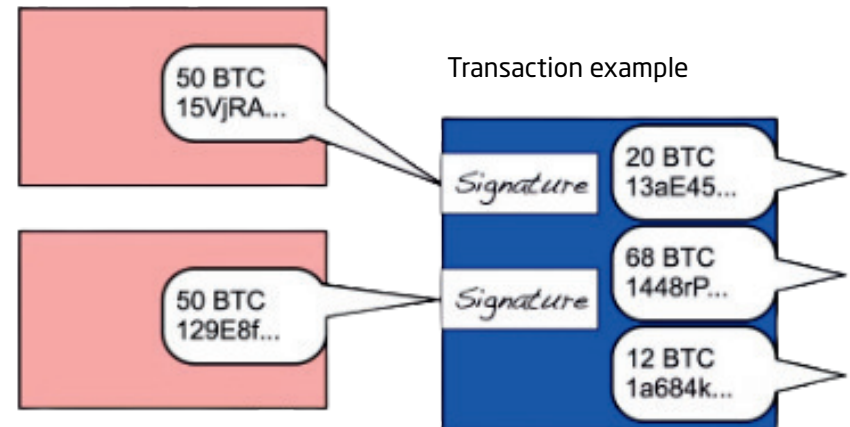
There are somewhere between 20 and 30 thousand nodes connected at any given time; any given node is connected to between 8 and 150 mostly-randomly-selected neighbors. ☞

Bitcoin generation will slow...



... over the next 50 years

☞ Block reward cut in half every 4 years, to artificially limit supply. Designed to be like extracting a natural resource. Divisible to 8 decimal places, so ultimate supply is 2.1 quadrillion of smallest possible unit. ☞



Will the Bitcoin Experiment Succeed?

☞ Bitcoin is getting a lot of hype right now, both positive and negative, and it is easy to forget that it is really still an experiment.



There has been nothing like it before, so nobody knows how the experiment will turn out.

Maybe the world doesn't need or won't want a decentralized Internet-based currency, Maybe it will be overrun with criminals and people will lose trust in it. Maybe it will be a niche currency used only by crypto-geeks to buy geeky T-shirts from each other. ☞

Lessons learned from a 7+ hours electrical blackout in Spain

3665 sats \ 19 comments \ @klk 29 Apr security

#966046



Yesterday there was a complete electricity blackout affecting Spain and Portugal and partly other neighbor countries. At around 12:30 everything just shut off. First I've checked if it was just my house as usual, then the neighbors, and finally realized that there was no electricity anywhere around me. The phone network was not working either but I still had internet access through optical fiber since the router is connected to a UPS.

No news anywhere.

I've then proceeded to shut down the server which would finish the UPS battery in ~20 minutes and was not as important as keeping the router on.

I've tried to post in SN to inform and ask for updated. I couldn't because of course my Alby Hub was down... First lesson is to have more channels on my mobile node and to keep some custodial sats on SN...

Something that really helped was Meshtastic (decentralized wireless off-grid mesh networking LoRa protocol). I could talk with people all around my city and share updates. I also managed to have a friend visit a relative that's old and was alone. At home I sourced as many batteries as possible and connected them to the UPS once the internal once was over. But they didn't last much. I then lost internet access, GSM was still not working and the optical fiber router was out of power).

I decided to go to a more or less nearby department store to get a large solar panel, a large lead battery, charge controllers and cables. I paid with cash... Would have been in a bad position without it. Lightning wouldn't have worked even if it was accepted, but I would like to learn if this can be fixed/improved somehow.

Anyway, the solar panel I bought was just a bit too large and didn't fit. Of course I couldn't contact my friend with a van to ask for help. I've tried asking around in the parking lot to people with large vehicles but everyone had other plans (understandable). I went back and change it for a smaller, less powerful, and more expensive one.

All the navigation with the car was smooth with OpenStreetMap. Once home, I disassembled the UPS and connected it to the new large battery. We had internet again. And I've placed the solar panel outside to charge the depleted UPS batteries.

Some neighbors came by and were happy to have internet access and a way to charge their phones.

I've cooked dinner in the gas stove and kept chatting on Meshtastic. After a few hours, 8 in total in my case, the electricity came back. I had my mains off to protect me from the spike and after I heard some neighbors celebrating the return to the 21st Century, I switched on mine.

I think I was in a very good situation given the circumstances. But others had huge problems moving around without traffic lights, trains, subway, tram, ... And there were lots of people stuck in elevators, or with a need for assisted breathing at home and stuff like that.

Oh, and by the way, no gas station worked... Because guess what, the pumps run on electricity... And some areas didn't have water because they needed electric pumps for pressure.

What do you think? Any tips for next time?



TLDR:

- No electricity means no communications most of the time. Get Meshtastic.
- You need to have a bit of solar capacity, a large charged battery, and an inverter to be able to plug stuff to it.
- Keep cash, or assume you won't be able to buy anything.
- Keep some sats in SN for emergencies xD.

205 sats \ 0 replies \ @criptopanas 29 Apr

Thanks for sharing your experience and knowledge!

I was traveling from BCN to Porto. our flight was on time, but the situation in Oporto was more chaotic than BCN. No telephones, no water and no electricity. The lines for the taxis were huge, UBER was out of service, most of the cars are electric and the only way to call are on the APP.

Our taxi driver told us, that some taxis were out of gas and the gas station were closed...

It was a odd experience seeing people buying paper maps and trying to using them while driving...without Google Maps, most of the tourist and some locals are lost...

We made to the house fine, we went to some groceries shop to buy some water and the only option was 0,5 lts bottle.

187 sats \ 0 replies \ @optimism 29 Apr

@gandlaf21 is doing awesome work to improve offline usability w/ cashu: #943832. It's not lightning and there are custodial elements to this (the mint) but bottom line, holding a couple of offline spendable emergency "cash" sats in there may not be the worst thing until we have another breakthrough?

104 sats \ 0 replies \ @BallLightning 29 Apr

In that line of thought when I ask people here about offline lightning payment i get "smart" (in quotes of course) responses like "If you don't have internet and power you have bigger problems." Yeah, thanks.

I Think the Feds Took Down My Bitcoin Meetup Poster

681 sats \ 10 comments \ @unschooled 29 Apr bitcoin

#967135

I'm pretty sure the feds took down my bitcoin meetup poster.

Not once, but twice, it happened.

I'd been promoting a Bitcoin meetup I hosted in my locale (notes and resources published here: #958945), so I put up a poster on a cafe bulletin board and twice I returned to find it had been taken down. I was shocked since I'd done my diligence by getting permission from the shopkeeper. I ended up asking them what they thought could have happened, and they gave the excuse that they don't have a line of sight to the bulletin board.

Well, the cafe is in the city center, close to a federal employee office, so the most plausible case scenario is that some numbskull, property-rights-disrespecting government lackey came in on their lunch and didn't like what they saw. The third time, I saved them the trouble of un-tacking and left several posters on the table next the bulletin. Nice try feds.

This is the poster - can you believe it got taken down?



At any rate, how did the meetup go? you ask. It was swell indeed.

We had a rando boomer lady who thought she was attending a French lesson mosey in, and I got her to stay and learn about bitcoin instead (using a simple persuasion tactic involving coffee and baked goods). She was engaged and asked some good questions. Total, the group consisted of myself and another bitcoiner, and three no-coiners. All of them asked when the next one would be.

The newbies were all interested in knowing what the difference is between crpto and Bitcoin, which confirmed my suspicions that the largest mental hurdle for this milieu is the psyop that bitcoin is somehow a scammy ponzi controlled by some elite tech-bros.

I'm hoping we can double our turnout for next time, which will just require each person to bring one friend. I don't expect this to be a problem. The attendees are all currently active in a telegram group where we continue to share resources and discuss.



Going Forward

Next meetup will be the end of May, so stay posted for updates in the ~events territory. I'll most likely not waste any more posters in the cafe. Since then, I've distributed more around the city.

P.s.

@plebpoet,

I'll have you know. I shamelessly flaunted my inaugural SN Zine to the attendees. Still shmoozing them to join here. Should be soon.

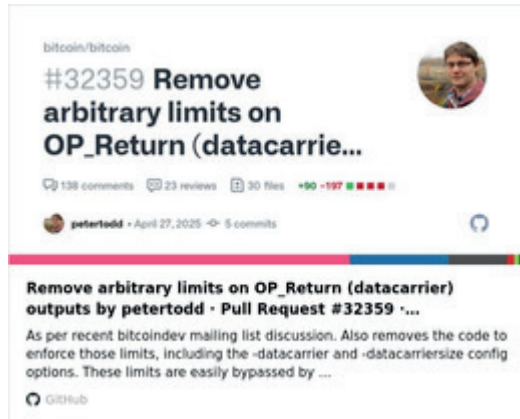
bring
our
troops
home



Powerful arguments for the 'meaning' of Bitcoin - What is going on?

1321 sats \ 26 comments \ @028559d218 29 Apr bitcoin

This post references:



#966733

This is "wizkid's" comments on the recent proposed changes to op_return in Bitcoin Core (what the vast majority of noderunners use)

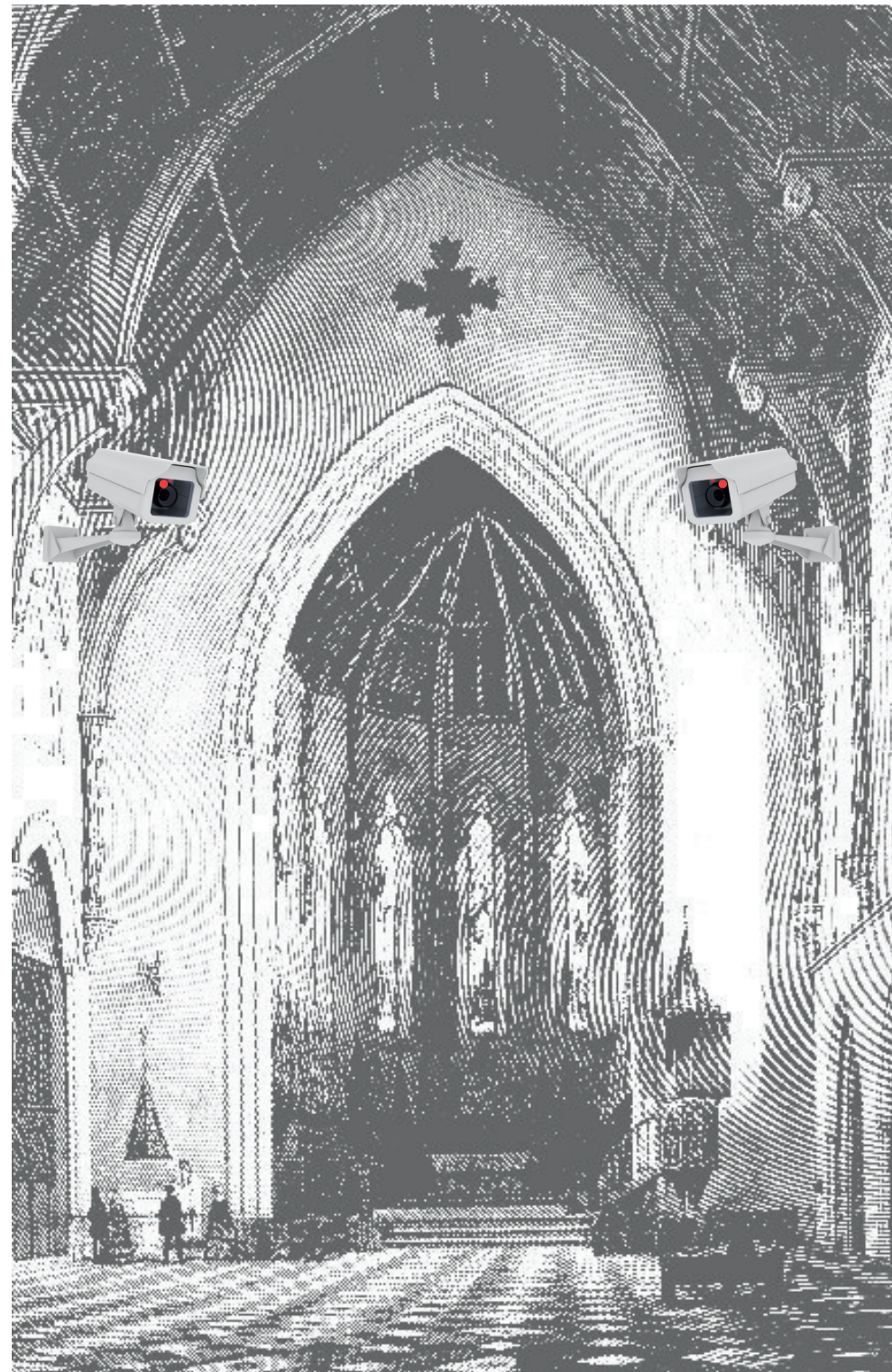
"This is far more than a small technical change, so the broader community should not be shut out of the discussion or shuffled off to the mailing list. This is a fundamental change to the nature of what the Bitcoin network itself is in its entirety."

Merging this PR means Bitcoin is no longer a decentralized currency.
Merging this PR means Bitcoin is no longer money.
Merging this PR means Bitcoin is no longer a store of value.
Merging this PR means Bitcoin is no longer what users, node runners, etc signed up for and adopted.
Merging this PR means Bitcoin is no longer Bitcoin.

"That may sound like hyperbole, but it really isn't. If this PR is merged, Bitcoin as we know it changes forever in the most fundamental way imaginable: The reference implementation explicitly turning the Bitcoin network into an arbitrary data storage system, instead of evolving it as a decentralized currency."

What do the Stackers think of this?

Does reducing the limits on op_return really make the arbitrary data storage on Bitcoin worse? Isn't it already out of control? If Op_return unspendable outputs can carry practically 'unlimited' data (like they can in the Witness already) is anything really being changed?



Don't we have a growing issue with UTXO dust and economically unspendable outputs... either due to the sizes of the UTXOs, or even from public keys implemented as arbitrary data? (Fake keys)

I remember the last halving block, 840000 filled with OP_Return. The limit was (and is) 80 bytes... And yet "runes" memecoins only employ ~10 bytes or so of data. The amount of data "needed" for Runes is minuscule and morons are gambling on memecoins "created" on Bitcoin with data far less than the maximum allowed 'standard.' It's a tiny amount of information used... to mark gambling chips employed by morons. It has been essentially impossible to stop because... op_return exists?

And... It's not like op_return is anything "new" - it was created for arbitrary data storage in the least harmful way possible... with verifiably 'prunable' outputs...

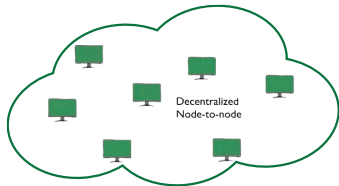
- But on the other hand... how long is it going to take the spammers and scammers to upload 'reams' of data within OP_Return just to sell more JPegs or memecoins or scams? Why should gamblers get to dictate what Bitcoin is for?

Bitcoin is about sound and transparent capital, sound money unique to the individual NOT arbitrary data storage or cloud storage nonsense.

How do we stop "this" (whatever "this" is) and what do we do about it?

I can "run" Bitcoin knots (it's easy to do on Umbrel) however the arbitrary data is still consensus valid so even if it's not "in my mempool" it's still being stored on my node.

- In Witness data.
- IN OP_Return.
- In dust outputs...



How high do fees need to go (and they need to go really high eventually in the face of declining subsidy) in order to "outprice" the spammers and scammers so that they eventually give up? In the face of "high demand" will there be demand for arbitrary data?

If fees are "high enough" and Bitcoin "valuable enough" to replace the subsidy completely... who would waste Bitcoin on Memecoin Scams and Monkey Pictures?

What is the Best thing to do?

1864 sats \ 14 replies \ @optimism 29 Apr

When it looks like hyperbole and it moves like hyperbole, it probably is hyperbole? I'd not worry about the existential crisis some people assign to it, but that doesn't mean there's not an underlying issue here.

Does reducing the limits on op_return really make the arbitrary data storage on Bitcoin worse? Isn't it already out of control? If Op_return unspendable outputs can carry practically 'unlimited' data (like they can in the Witness already) is anything really being changed?

It isn't; except it gets technically easier at the cost of fee sats.

With the current proposal, as long as the segwit discount exists, witness script data abuse is still cheaper. This was raised on the mailing list today by the

same author:

"Relaxing OP_RETURN size limits without dealing with the inscriptions exploit means no one will use this for anything besides attacking the network with the worst possible data. There's little to no incentive to use OP_RETURN for data storage when using the 'inscriptions' exploit costs 4x less in transactions. What's the point of having a "standard" way to store arbitrary data if the exploit method is 4x cheaper? And the nonstandard version of the exploit allows 4x the data?"

Sjors said something rather smart about this in response:

"There is no point in restricting transactions that are 4x more expensive than the alternative."

He's right about this: it actually means there is no point in doing NACK on the PR for this reason.

The only remaining issue is that new spam "protocol" implementations will be easier to implement and thus may attract a whole ton of bad actors (or will, according to Murphy's law), but then to your other point, abusers will most likely just lose tons of sats to their petty get-rich-quick schemes and will run out of cash eventually while in the short-mid term possibly congesting the network.

PS: I'm not sure why Sjors is mentioning that removing the segwit discount is a hardfork. I'll have to dig a bit deeper to try and understand his p.o.v. better, right now I suspect it has to do with optimum economic usage of the blockspace always dictating that less functional space should be cheaper than more functional space - perhaps in ratio to their availability (!!!)

What's the best thing to do?

Properly discuss it. As much as I love Peter's no-nonsense "let's do it" PR, it probably needs to be discussed a bit because the last script element size constraint change brought us inscriptions as an unintended side-effect...

Discussing takes patience, listening to people you may dislike, some debate outside of safe channels, and all the other things we haven't seen an awful lot of lately... I'm sitting here and reading, hoping for a win for "team discourse without escalation"

112 sats \ 1 reply \ @028559d218 OP 29 Apr

Thank you for your comment. This discussion is so interesting to me.

As much as I want to avoid network congestion... the crazy thing is that it's *not* that congested, not really. Blocks are still 1-2 sats/vb even with both monetary txs and the spam sometimes it goes up to 3... but the fees are low let's face it. I believe that 'low demand' for transactions low utilization is a far greater threat than basically any amount of spam because while spam can cause 'high fees' for short periods, it's only speculative. Who buys the jpeg "off of me". If people don't and can't want to transact... with declining subsidy that's a problem. In my opinion this isn't talked about enough.

I agree with "doing nothing" when it's not clear what to do.

A slightly different perspective though... it wasn't the 'script element size constraint' that brought the inscriptions.

It was the Human Beings that wanted to gamble on

nonsense/cartoons/speculate etc. They are ultimately responsible.

If a 10kb jpeg needs to exceed 60k sats value at 2 sats/vb to "break even" (if I'm understanding this right)...

then at 10x demand for blockspace, at 20 sats/vb it's 600k sats to 'break even'?

And if Bitcoin were 5x more valuable in exchange then... 600k sats is ~3000\$.

So the jpeg has to be re-sell-able for at least 3000\$ to 'break even'? PLUS the overhead costs so 3000\$ to sell the JPEG makes it break even but that doesn't incorporate profit for the scammer.

100 sats \ 0 replies \ @optimism 29 Apr

Exactly! Not break-even but make sense economically. Break even would be 1x - that too is crazy. But then... stupid algo-generated monkey pics go for millions - we live in an insane world.

423 sats \ 0 replies \ @Murch 29 Apr

It takes about 10% of nodes accepting a transaction for it to be reliably relayed to miners.

A minority of nodes with more restrictive mempool policies is mostly detrimental to themselves. They are missing transactions from the compact block relay and therefore receive blocks more slowly, have an incomplete mempool for feerate estimation, and presumably slightly increased traffic with their peers, and if they are mining, they pick from a smaller pool of eligible transactions, therefore earning less fees (although fees are currently anyway a vanishing portion of the overall block reward).

.....

While I care not for the whole frog picture on the blockchain thing, it feels to me like a "cut off your nose to spite your face" reaction to run a node with such a configuration.

OP_RETURNS are less harmful than other ways of storing data in the blockchain. Storing data in the blockchain is a millions of dollars business. It's going to happen despite the noseless zealots, if only because the nodes run by frog picture enthusiasts would be configured to forward them. We are already seeing bigger OP_RETURN outputs in blocks.

The way I see it, we can either have people build out ways to submit transactions directly to mining pools, depriving the rest of the network from having full information and benefiting disproportionately the largest miners, or we can loosen the limits to at least keep the mempool mostly complete, and prevent further incentives to centralize mining.

Anyway, putting data into OP_RETURN outputs is only cheaper than inscriptions for payloads smaller than 143 bytes.

So, if we take a step back and soberly look at the situation, it seems quixotic and detrimental to keep the OP_RETURN limits in place.

105 sats \ 0 replies \ @unschooled 29 Apr

I'll be honest I'm very unsure what to make of it all at this point.

What's concerning to me, as @optimism alluded to already (#966683), is that some feel as though the Bitcoin Core repo is theirs, a perspective that gets dignified when voices (not so-called 'brigaders', but people with proven clout in the bitcoin space) are being effectively censored in discussions.

Feels a little antithetical to foss to me.

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

238 sats \ 15 comments \ @sn 28 Apr memes bot

5049 sats \
0 replies \
@geeknik
28 Apr

badge of
the proud
crypto-geek

